NO.48 群集心理(1)

You are on your way to a concert. At an intersection, you encounter a group of people, all staring at the sky. Without even thinking about it, you look upwards, too. Why? Social proof. In the middle of the concert, when the *soloist is giving an excellent performance, someone begins to clap and suddenly the whole room joins in. You do, too. Why? Social proof. After the concert you go to the coat check to pick up your coat. You watch how the people in front of you place a coin on a plate, even though, officially, the service is included in the ticket price. What do you do? You probably leave 10 a coin as well. Why? Social proof.

Social proof, sometimes roughly termed the herd instinct, dictates that individuals feel they are behaving correctly when they act the same as other people. In other words, if a large number of people follow a certain idea, others will find this idea truer or better. And the more people who display a certain behavior, the more appropriate others will judge it. This is, of course, ridiculous. Social proof is the evil behind economic bubbles and stock market panic. It exists in fashion, management techniques, hobbies, religion and diets. In some cases, it can even negatively affect whole cultures.

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*　soloist「ソリスト：独奏者」

1	stare	自動詞・名詞	じっと見る(こと)
2	gaze	自動詞・名詞	見つめる(こと)
3	glance	自動詞・名詞	ちらりと見る(こと)
4	proof	名詞	証拠
5	whole	形容詞	全体の・丸ごとの・全体
6	check	名詞・他動詞	検査・小切手・を調べる・を阻止する
7	instinct	名詞	本能
8	follow	他動詞	に従う・の後に起こる・の跡を継ぐ
9	precede	他動詞	より先に起こる
10	display	他動詞・名詞	を表す・を展示する・展示(品)・表現
11	exhibit	他動詞・名詞	を展示する・を示す・展示(品)
12	gallery	名詞	画廊・美術館・バルコニー・観客
13	appropriate	形容詞	適切な
14	judge	他動詞・名詞	を判断する・を砂漠・裁判官・審判
15	ridiculous	形容詞	ばかげた
16	absurd	形容詞	ばかげた
17	silly	形容詞	愚かな
18	stupid	形容詞	ばかな
19	fool	名詞・他動詞	愚か者・をばかにする
20	evil	名詞・形容詞	害悪・邪悪・邪悪な
21	vice	名詞	悪(徳)
22	moral	名詞・形容詞	道徳規範・道徳的な
23	ethic	名詞	道徳・規範
24	stock	名詞・他動詞	株式・蓄え・在庫(品)・を貯蔵している
25	reserve	名詞・他動詞	蓄え・慎み・を取っておく・を予約する
26	exist	自動詞	存在する・生存する
27	fashion	名詞	流行・やり方・流儀
28	boom	名詞	大流行・にわか景気

29	management	名詞	経営(者)・取り扱い
30	boss	名詞	社長・雇用主・上司
31	executive	名詞・形容詞	(経営)幹部・執行権のある・行政の
32	president	名詞	社長・会長・学長・大統領
33	hobby	名詞	趣味
34	justice	名詞	正義・公正・裁判(官)
35	court	名詞	法廷・裁判所(官)
36	trial	名詞	裁判・試み・試練
37	prison	名詞	刑務所・拘置所

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